

Navigate to:

HCR\...xxx\OpenWithList

Replace “...xxx” with the file extension in three-letter format that you want to delete. So in our case, go to HCR\...bmp\OpenWithList. Delete the Internet Explorer *key* entirely.

Usually, the first action as above does not require a restart, and the second does.

In addition, our consciences would hate us if we didn’t tell you this: there exist a *few* programs for which neither of the above will work, but to remove those involves a dangerous Registry hack, which we won’t get into here.

Windows Forgetting Your Settings?

This may seem a bug at first, but it turns out it’s not a bug—it’s more of an irritant, which is much less likely in XP SP2. Windows sometimes forgets your folder customisations: their positions and display options, and in addition, if you’ve customised them by setting a picture as a background for them, and such. This happens because XP remembers the settings for only 400 folders by default, and when you customise more folders, the 400 mark is reached, and the old settings are lost.

XP happens to allow a maximum of 8000 instead of that 400. Here’s how to set it to any value up to 8000.

Navigate to:

HCU\Software\Microsoft\Windows\Shell

And to:

HCU\Software\Microsoft\Windows\ShellNoRoam

In both these keys, find the value called BagMRU. Increase it to whatever you want, all the way to 8000. (This is in decimal; make sure “decimal” is chosen when you’re making the change. God